

No. 749, April 2012

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

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Heading back to the hut
Image courtesy of Kevin Patterson

Next section night: 4 July, 2011

Nomadic Creative – Scribbling, Snapshots and Nick Cave, by Fraser Crichton

Wilderness Magazine columnist and photographer Fraser Crichton talks about writing, photography and the outdoors. If you want to climb grade 30 or summit Mt Cook then this might not be the evening for you. If you want to know more about the rule of thirds, a good pitch on paper and poor excuses for not writing then perhaps you'll be entertained.



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

Haidinger and Spencer

Kevin Patterson and Kyle Wendling

One Sunday in early December, after a quick game of cricket, and while the weather was looking good, I jumped on a standby flight to Christchurch to join with Kyle for some alpine fun. We quickly motored to Fox and choppered into Pioneer Hut the next morning where we eventually met the Wellington six led by Rob Hawes. It was too late in the day (10am) to climb Haidinger (3070m, grade 3), but we thought we would have a look at its south ridge.

By 2pm we had made it to Governor Col and a third of the way along the south ridge in inclement conditions – visibility was poor (30–50m) and the rock/snow was loose and corniced. Difficult to see where to go so we called it a day

Next day weather had set in – still, we had a go at the “TV slab” next to Mt Alack. Of-

ficially goes at about rock grade 14/15 which felt about right, but the pro was poor so we traversed around the corner to the left. Where it got worse! Going at about grade 17, it was brilliantly lead by Kyle on the second pitch.

Wednesday was even worse weather, so it wasn't until Thursday that we had another crack at Haidinger, this time by the route the Wellington six had done on Monday – the West Ridge. We were away from the hut by 4am. Conditions were steep and icy requiring front pointing and two tooling the entire 600m route – tedious and hazardous. Steepness varied from 40 to 60 degrees.

As we neared the summit headwall, the rope came out. The headwall went via a 20m couloir on the left at about WI2 – this was the best

Kyle on the pitch leading to the headwall of Haidinger



part of the climb. We were on top at 10am– six hours up. This was 2 hours slower than the Wellington six, possibly indicating that the conditions were becoming icier requiring more care than three days earlier. We took three 50m raps off the summit before we started to solo down-climb. This was two tooling all the way down as well – not much fun. All up it was a twelve hour return trip from the hut.

We had decided that the grade 3 peaks around Pioneer Hut were becoming too icy so on Friday bailed to Centennial Hut and easier grade 1–2 peaks. On the way there we had a go at Mt Spencer via the North Ridge (2798m, grade 1+). We left Pioneer at 5am and were at the base at 7am.

From the top of the glacier Spencer looked steep and tricky. We headed up the steep gully in the middle and then traversed left through a lot of steep loose rock and soft snow. Each step felt tenuous, requiring movement of just one limb at a time, and a lot of deep breaths! Possibly the slope on the right would have been a better option? It would have required ascending 50–60 degree ice to get there, though. The summit was achieved at 10am. The descent was just as difficult, a two tool front point job all the way down the snow couloir on the left of where I went up. Not really Grade 1+, and it felt harder than Haidinger.



Kevin on
first pitch
of TV Slab

Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

12th/13th - 16th April: Cloudy Peak alpine rock climbing (Westland Alps)

Trip organiser: Adam Power

This is an alpine climbing trip that targets a range of routes on Hourglass Wall of Cloudy Peak. Access is via flight to Christchurch and up the Rangitata River from Erewhon Station. The wall offers multipitch climbs in a great setting and with a range of difficulties, including Ytivarg-17 or Great prow (hardest pitch grade 15). If the weather allows there will be time for a couple of routes. Participants need solid trad / alpine rock climbing experience.

Return is with the first flight back from CHC on April 16th.

For more info and sign up contact Adam at adamipower@yahoo.com or 021 0269 8151.



6-8 July: North Island Ice Climbing Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Adam Power

This is a 6 day ice/mixed climbing trip to Mt. Ruapehu. The plan is to spend three nights at Ruapehu Hut and three more nights at Tukino Lodge to join the North Island Ice Climbing Meet. Participants are welcome for part of or the whole trip. Climbers should have ice and or mixed experience or must have robust alpine experience and be eager to learn these techniques. Possible routes and areas include: Barium Enema Face, Cathedral Rocks, East Buttress of Girdlestone, Chiming Bells and many more.

For information and sign up contact Adam at adamipower@yahoo.com or 021 0269 8151



Cathedral Rocks (photo by Adam Power)

August 2012: Mt. Murchison (Arthur's Pass)

Trip organiser: Mark Hooker.

28-30 September: North Island Ski Touring Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Magnus Hammarsal at hammarsal@gmail.com (Auckland Section).

Notices

Winter Instruction Programme

Registration for the NZAC Winter Instruction Courses is now open!

There are three courses on offer:

- Mountain Skills for Youth
- Introduction to Back Country Skiing

- Progression to Leading on Technical Ice

For information and registration forms, go to: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine>

Mountain Skills for Youth Scholarship

The NZAC is offering a scholarship for one participant on the Mountain Skills for Youth Course. The winning application will get the course for free.

For details and an application form for the scholarship, check here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine>

The Climber Magazine 80th Issue Creative Writing Competition

This is open to all readers of the magazine. The topic should be about the mountains or a climbing/snow/ice related sport. 1500 word maximum. Deadline April 30th. Send your

creations to Pat at: pat@alpineclub.org.nz as a MS Word, RTF or text file attachment, or post to PO BOX 786, Christchurch.

Creative Writing Course

Well known mountain author Paul Hersey is running a Creative Writing Course as part of the Unwin Art Workshop series. This will take place at Unwin Lodge, 22-25 June.

If you have ever fancied yourself as a writer,

now it your chance to get some quality instruction from one of the best.

Check here for info and registration details: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/unwin/arts-workshops>

NZAC payments – credit card security

Please note that from April we will be unable to process credit card payments without 3-digit security pin number (CSC) from the back of the card. We are having new hut fee payment forms printed to allow for this extra detail. I'd appreciate anyone coming across old forms, or brochures in NZAC huts that don't ask for a CVV2/CVC2 number, to please send them into National Office and let me know where they

came from for replacement. We will add the new requirement with a stamp and reuse them, so don't hiff them please.

In preference, for security of your credit card details, we recommend you take advantage of our new online hut payment area: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/hut-misc>

Hut fee payments now online

We now have the facility in place for NZAC hut fees to be paid online. Please follow this link for Visa/MasterCard and internet banking

payments: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/hut/payment>

Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival August 16th–19th 2012

The inaugural Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival will be held at Queenstown on 16–19 August.

This event will bring together the top winter alpine climbers in New Zealand as a means of advancing and promoting modern mixed climbing, and will showcase the new and existing route potential on New Zealand's most accessible multipitch winter training area. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships will be a key aim, and all festival

attendees will receive the latest guide for the Remarkables. This will have over 30 unclimbed routes and detailed information on more than 150 possible summer and winter climbs.

For further details and info on how to register, visit <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/>

<http://www.facebook.com/#!/pages/Remarkables-Ice-Mixed-Festival/130651843714800>

Mt Arrowsmith Images Request

Alice Doughty would like to thank all the mountaineers who contributed photographs of the Cameron Glacier. Her studies on the impact of snow avalanches on glacier mass balance is made clearer by these images and the photographer(s) will be acknowledged with

each time their photo appears in a presentation. She believes there is great potential for scientists to learn from general observations people make while in the mountains and your cooperation is appreciated.

FMC newsletter

The February newsletter is now available on the FMC website at:

<http://www.fmc.org.nz/wp-content/uploads/Newsletter/Club1203.pdf>

Mountain Photography Course – second course now scheduled

Due to popular demand a second four-day mountain photography course with renowned landscape photographer Colin Monteath is now scheduled for 22–25 June at the new improved Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook.

Christchurch-based Colin Monteath is a world renowned polar and mountain photographer who has had 30 seasons in Antarctica and four in the Arctic. He has climbed and trekked throughout the Southern Alps since 1967 and around the world since 1974, including 21 expeditions to Himalayan countries. He has written 10 books and supplied images to many others. In 1984, after his return from the North Face of Everest, Colin set up a photo library www.hedgehoghouse.com. See also: www.colinmonteath.com

This course is aimed at keen “intermediate” digital or film photographers who want to extend their skills to produce better mountain landscape images. Course participants will have all their own camera equipment and, if shooting

digitally, an ability to download files into their own portable computer.

There will be evening lectures on adventures and expedition photojournalism as well as sessions to discuss techniques and raw file processing. The course aims to spend one night in Mueller Hut to take images of the sunset and dawn.

Course cost: \$750 per person, which includes all instruction, accommodation and transport Chch-Mt Cook-Chch if required and evening meals on the nights of the 12th/13th/14th and 15th.

You will be required to pay a \$300 non refundable deposit to secure your place on the course. Cancellation insurance is available. Applicants must be members of the NZAC (Full info available on the NZAC website: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2012/an-opportunity-not-to-be-missed-four-day-mountain-photography-workshop-with-colin-monteath>).

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
	Nina Sawicki	NS	
	Dan Pringle	DP	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Fraser Crichton		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	vacant	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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Boulder Series starts 25th June

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